A: Unique design is becoming increasingly important. Consumers want something with a specific inspiration and identity. Serpenti has always had a distinctive feminine design. Not every woman will want it, and we understand that. But it is unmistakably a design of its own. We have continued adding technical sophistication to our designs. What interests me particularly today is bringing that level of expertise into feminine calibres. Women are increasingly interested in technical watchmaking. This allows us to bring the expertise developed with Finissimo to our women's collections.

Q: Moving on to India, what is your strategy for the watchmaking business here?
A: Watchmaking is a unique category because it is about much more than products. It is rooted to a particular savoir-faire and to a region in Switzerland. Our manufacture is in the Vallée de Joux, where we produce our calibres.

There is a very human dimension to this industry. When you visit our manufactures, you realise that our Swiss watchmakers are doing much more than simply making products. This connection with Switzerland and its traditions is something Indian consumers appreciate.



India has had a major jewellery tradition for 3,000 years, while watchmaking is a category that consumers have been discovering more recently. I believe there is a natural connection between Indian culture and Swiss watchmaking because collectors appreciate the local expertise and craftsmanship behind these timepieces. Jewellery already has a long history in India. I am confident that watchmaking can follow a similar trajectory.

Q: What personal touch is Bvlgari bringing to Indian consumers? How do you make the brand relevant to the local market?
A: It is difficult to identify which elements of a brand's DNA resonate with a local culture. In India, perhaps it is our generosity, our Latin roots, or our connection with architecture. Our approach to the brand and the way we express Roman and Italian creativity can resonate with Indian consumers. We try to come across as who we are as a brand, present our symbols and icons, and hopefully connect with consumers through emotion. We recently introduced a local initiative for the Diwali festive season called Passing the Lights. It brought together 4,500 lights, arranged to echo the shape of a Serpenti.

"Women are increasingly interested in technical watchmaking. This allows us to bring the expertise developed with Finissimo to our women's collections"

The idea was to take a distinctive cultural moment, with its diyas and lights, and add a little sparkle and a twist that reflected who we are. Culture and luxury have a deep connection, but that connection works when the maison's DNA resonates with an element of the country's culture. We are a Roman brand and will not change our heritage. However, when we can create bridges with local relevance, that is where the magic happens.